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Miner Staff, Field 'Better'

Andy Cohen is looking to cure a few ills.

U.T.-El Paso's baseball team impressed a 16-11 non-conference record last year but fell completely apart in Western Athletic Conference play with a 2-16 mark.

The reason? The Miner pitching staff couldn't effectively stop the hot bats of Arizona State, Arizona and New Mexico plus the defense was porous.

HOPEFULLY 1974 will see a reversal in these two areas and Miner coach Cohen is optimistic of changes.

"Our pitching staff and defense are definitely better

than last year," remarked Cohen. "The attitude of everyone out here is great. They have come out to play heads up ball."

Cohen said that his main problem in defense was finding a stable shortstop. Right now there is an intense battle between David Nance, David Patt and Ted Hudson for the spot. Last year's regular shortstop Herb von Hagen has moved out to centerfield where his speed will be of good use.

SECOND BASE is stable with Mark Miller while sophomore Glen Villareal holds down third base. Battling for first base is Terry Dillingham, Mike Sanchez and Bob Downing. Mike Miller and Jim Brundage are the backstops.

"We have good competition among our pitchers," Cohen added. "Dan Modlinsky is really looking good. Mike Hilton and Bob Knox are also impressive."

NBA Standings

EASTERN CONFERENCE ATLANTIC DIVISION

	W	L	Pct	GB
Boston	35	12	.745	—
New York	31	21	.596	6 1/2
Buffalo	26	28	.481	12 1/2
Philadelphia	15	35	.300	21 1/2

CENTRAL DIVISION

	W	L	Pct	GB
Capital	27	22	.551	—
Atlanta	23	30	.434	6
Cleveland	19	35	.352	10 1/2